



GLASSBLOWING

In glassblowing, a long tube is used to blow air into hot, softened glass to form a bubble, which can then be shaped, as seen here. Specialized pieces of laboratory glassware and expensive decorative items such as vases are still made today using this technique.

**Gold salts
can be added to
molten glass
to give it a rich
ruby-red
color.**

New from old

At this factory in Italy, extremely hot blobs of used glass are shaped into new bottles. Machines mix small pieces of crushed glass with other raw materials before heating it to more than 2,732°F (1,500°C), producing a new bottle. Glass is infinitely recyclable, so this process can happen many times.